Ad Health Dashboard

How it works — a plain-language guide

For the monitoring person, the brand marketing team and the business owner. No technical knowledge needed.

Home Cartel Marketing · October 15, 2026

Inside: what the dashboard does · how to read it · how to update it · pop-ups and emails · what to do when something turns red · daily routine · troubleshooting

1. What is this, in one minute?

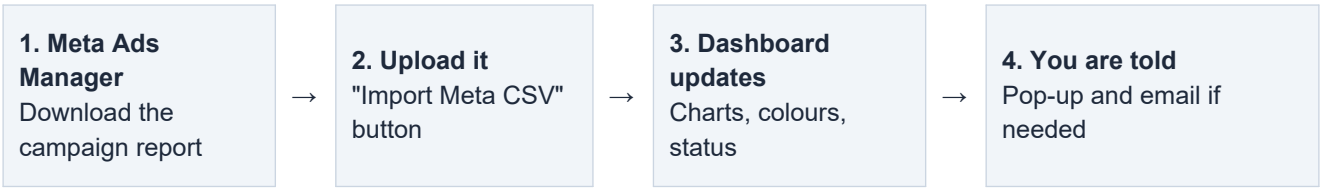
The Ad Health Dashboard is a web page that tells you **whether your Meta (Facebook and Instagram) ads are healthy** — before they waste your budget. Think of it like a car dashboard: green means keep driving, amber means look at it soon, red means stop and fix it now.

It answers three questions every day:

- **Is any campaign in trouble?** (people seeing the same ad too many times, or hardly anyone clicking)
- **How much money is at risk?** (how much of your spend is going into campaigns that are not healthy)
- **What should we do about it?** (a short checklist for each problem)

How the information gets there

The dashboard does **not** watch Meta live. You give it the numbers by uploading a report file (a "CSV" file, which is just a spreadsheet) from Meta Ads Manager. Each time you upload a fresh file, everything on the dashboard updates by itself.



> **Important: it is not live**
> The numbers are only as fresh as the last file you uploaded. The top of the Ad Health section always shows **"data as of ..."** and the date range of the report, so everyone can see how old the information is.

2. Opening the dashboard

1. Open your web browser (Chrome, Edge, Brave or Safari).
2. Go to the dashboard address your team uses. At the time of writing it is **homecartel-conversiontrackingsystem.up.railway.app** (ask your admin if it has changed). Add **/dashboard** at the end if you land on a different page.
3. Sign in with the username and password your admin gave you. You stay signed in for about 12 hours.
4. Scroll down to the section called **Ad Health Monitor**. That is the main part of this guide.

> **Tip**
> If a window pops up as soon as the page opens, that is the alert pop-up (section 7). It means a campaign needs attention. Read it, then press **Dismiss**.

3. Reading the Ad Health Monitor

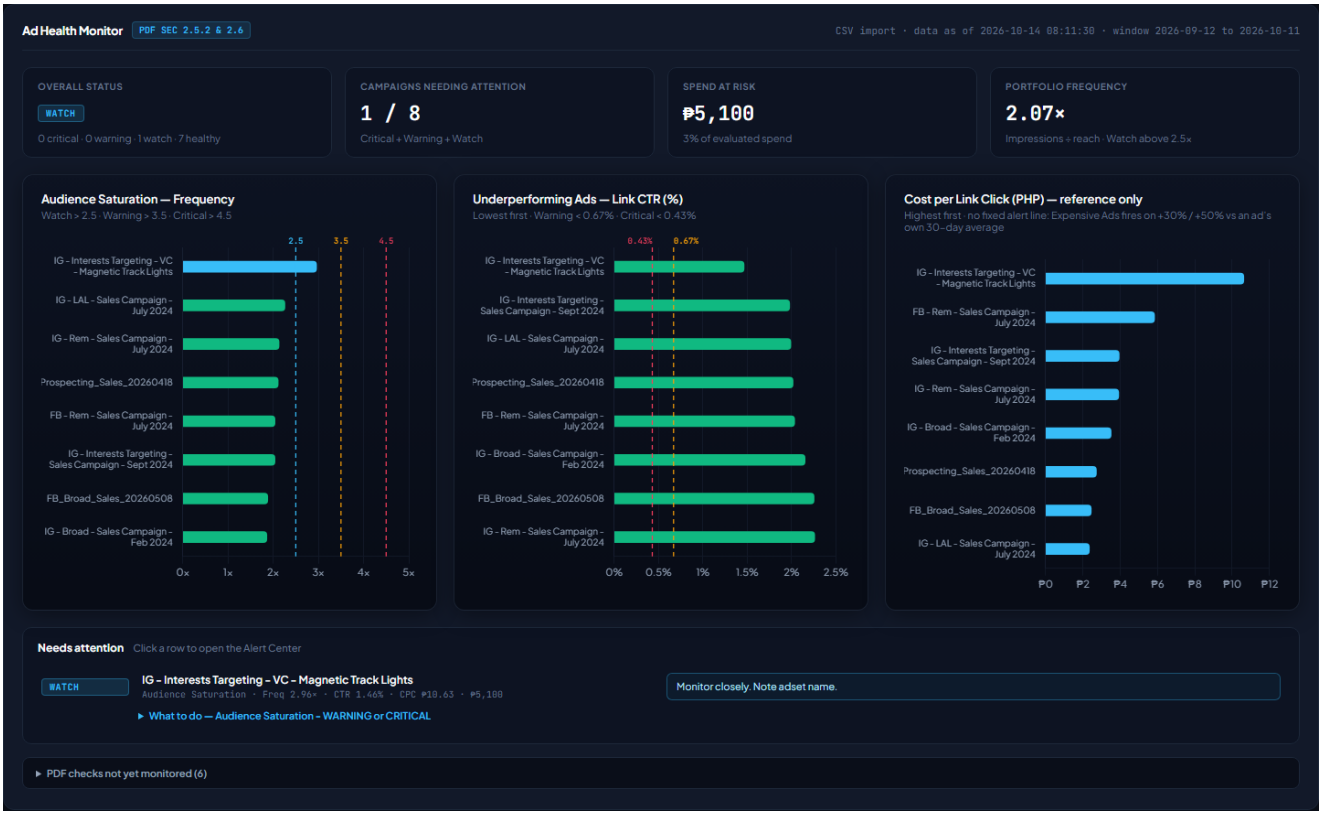


Figure 1 — The Ad Health Monitor (real numbers from our latest report).

A. The line at the top right

It says where the numbers came from and how old they are, for example *"CSV import · data as of 2026-10-14 · window 2026-09-12 to 2026-10-11"*. "Window" is the period the report covers. Always check this first.

B. The four tiles

Tile	What it tells you
Overall status	The worst colour among all your active campaigns. If one campaign is Critical, the whole status says Critical. Underneath it counts how many campaigns are in each colour.
Campaigns needing attention	For example "1 / 8" means 1 out of 8 active campaigns is not healthy.
Spend at risk	The total money spent on the campaigns that are not healthy, and what share of all spend that is. A big number here means a lot of budget is going into a problem.
Portfolio frequency	On average, how many times each person saw your ads. It turns blue when it goes above 2.5×.

C. The three charts

Each bar is one campaign. Coloured dotted lines show where the warning levels start. A bar that crosses a dotted line has a problem.

Chart	What it shows	How to read it
Audience Saturation — Frequency	How many times the same person saw the ads of that campaign.	Highest first. Dotted lines at 2.5 (blue = Watch), 3.5 (amber = Warning) and 4.5 (red = Critical). Longer bar = people are getting tired of the ad.
Underperforming Ads — Link CTR (%)	Out of 100 people who saw the ad, how many clicked the link.	Lowest first, because a *short* bar is the bad one. Dotted lines at 0.67% (amber) and 0.43% (red). Below the lines = too few clicks.
Cost per Link Click (reference only)	How many pesos each click costs.	Highest first. There is no alert line on purpose: this chart is for comparing campaigns, not for raising alarms.

D. "Needs attention"

A list of the campaigns that are not healthy, **worst first**. Each row shows the colour badge, the campaign name, the main problem, its numbers and a short instruction. Click the small blue **"What to do"** link under a row to open a step-by-step checklist. Click the row itself to jump to the Alert Center, a full table of all campaigns.

E. "PDF checks not yet monitored"

A closed box at the bottom that lists checks from the original plan that this version cannot do yet (for example daily trend lines and ad-by-ad rankings). They need a live link to Meta, which has not been set up. Nothing is broken — it is simply honest about what is not covered.

> **What is NOT checked**
> Campaigns whose name contains **"FR Stores"** (the Reach campaign) are always left out, because Reach campaigns naturally have very low clicks and would show false alarms every day. Campaigns that are paused or inactive are also left out.

4. The words used, in plain language

Word	Plain meaning	Example
Campaign	One advertising project in Meta, usually with a goal (like sales).	"IG - LAL - Sales Campaign - July 2024"
Impressions	How many times the ad was shown on screens.	100,000 impressions
Reach	How many *different* people saw the ad.	40,000 people
Frequency	Impressions divided by reach: the average number of times one person saw the ad.	100,000 ÷ 40,000 = 2.5×
Link CTR	Click-through rate: the percentage of people who clicked the link after seeing the ad. Higher is better.	1.5% = 15 clicks per 1,000 views
CPC	Cost per link click: what you pay for each click.	₱5.20 per click
Spend	The money used by the campaign in the report period.	₱25,000
Ad fatigue / saturation	People have seen the ad too often, get bored, and stop reacting. Results drop while the cost stays the same.	High frequency + falling clicks
Audience	The group of people the ad is shown to.	Women 25-45 in Metro Manila

5. What the colours mean

Every active campaign gets exactly one colour. The colour comes from fixed numbers we worked out from 16 months of our own ad history (about 2,284 ads), not from general internet advice.

Level	Triggered when	What to do	Who gets the email
HEALTHY	Everything is inside the safe range.	Nothing. Keep going.	No email
WATCH	Frequency above **2.5**	Keep an eye on it. Write down which ad set it is.	Monitoring person
WARNING	Frequency above **3.5** or Link CTR below **0.67%**	Act soon: widen the audience or change the creative; review the ad and plan a replacement within 3 days.	Monitoring person + brand team
CRITICAL	Frequency above **4.5** or Link CTR below **0.43%**	Act now: pause the ad or ad set that is burning money, then replace or widen it.	Monitoring person + brand team + business owner

If a campaign breaks more than one rule, it shows the most serious colour. The monitoring person only watches and passes things on; the brand team is the one who changes the ads.

6. Updating the numbers (upload a new report)

Do this as often as you want fresh numbers — for example every morning, or at least every week.

Step 1 — Download the report from Meta

1. Open **Meta Ads Manager** and click the **Campaigns** tab.
2. Pick the **date range** at the top right (for example the last 30 days).
3. Make sure the table shows these columns: **Campaign name, Delivery, Amount spent, Impressions, Reach, Link clicks, CPC (cost per link click) and CTR (link click-through rate)**. Use "Columns" to add any that are missing. Reach is important: without it, Frequency cannot be calculated.
4. Click **Reports** (or the export button) and choose **Export table data**, then **.csv**. The file downloads to your computer.

> Meta changes its menus from time to time, so the buttons may look a little different. What matters is that you end up with a **.csv** file of the Campaigns table with the columns above.

Step 2 — Upload it

1. On the dashboard, click **Import Meta CSV** (top right of the page).
2. Drag your file into the box, or click the box and choose the file.
3. Click **Upload & Sync Dashboard** and wait a few seconds.
4. A green message appears with the number of campaigns and the total spend. The window closes by itself and the dashboard refreshes.

What happens next, automatically

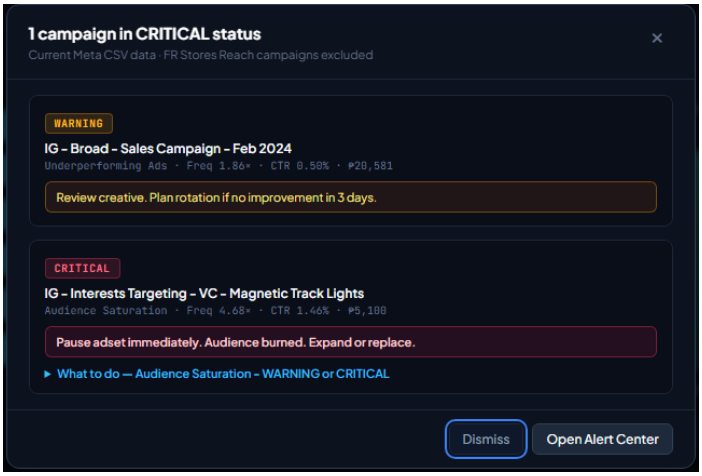
- Every chart, tile and list is recalculated from the new file — you do not need to reload the page.
- If any campaign has just become a problem, or got worse, a **pop-up** appears (section 7).
- The same campaigns trigger an **email** to the right people (section 8).

Good to know

- Campaigns are matched **by name**. A campaign already in the system gets its numbers replaced by the new file. A new name is added.
- A campaign that is **missing** from the new file is **not deleted** — its old numbers stay. If you stop a campaign, it may linger until someone asks the admin to clean it.
- Uploading the same file twice is harmless. Nothing new is flagged, so nobody gets a second email.
- The website online keeps its own copy of the data. Upload on the **live dashboard**, not just on your own computer.
- If you get an error, the file is probably not the Campaigns table (or the columns are missing). Re-export it and try again.

7. Pop-ups

A pop-up is a small window that appears in the middle of the screen so that serious problems cannot be missed.



When does it appear?

- When you open the dashboard and at least one campaign is **Warning** or **Critical**. It shows once per visit; if the list of problem campaigns changes, it shows again.
- Right after you upload a report, if a campaign is **new** in trouble or got **worse**.
- **Watch**-level campaigns do not get a pop-up. You only see a short message in the corner after an upload.

What can you do in it?

- Read each campaign: colour, name, the numbers and the instruction.
- Click **"What to do"** for the checklist.
- Press **Dismiss** (or the **Esc** key, or the ×) to close it.
- Press **Open Alert Center** to see every campaign in a table.

Figure 2 — Example pop-up (made-up numbers, for illustration only).

After an upload, the pop-up also tells you whether the email went out, for example *"Email sent for 2 alerts."* or *"Email not sent: no recipients configured."* The second message means the email settings have not been completed yet (see section 8).

8. Emails

The dashboard sends emails so that people hear about problems **without having to open the page**.

Email	When it is sent	Who receives it
Alert email	Right after a report upload, once per campaign that is **new** in trouble or got **worse** (for example Watch → Critical). Unchanged problems do not repeat. A campaign that recovers and later gets bad again is emailed again.	Watch: monitoring person. Warning: + brand team. Critical: + brand team + business owner.
Daily digest	Every morning at **8:00 AM** (Philippine time), even when nothing is wrong. Gives the overall status, how many campaigns are in each colour and the list that needs attention.	Monitoring person + business owner.

What an alert email contains

- A subject line that starts with the level and the brand, for example **[CRITICAL] — Home Cartel — Audience Saturation — 2026-10-15**.
- The campaign name, which number went over the line, what the line is, and what the level was before.
- The instruction, plus the step-by-step checklist when one exists.



Figure 3 — Example alert email (made-up numbers, for illustration only).

First upload

The very first upload after the system goes live has nothing to compare with, so it emails **every** campaign that is currently Watch, Warning or Critical, once. After that, only changes are emailed.

One-time setup by the admin

Emails only work after your admin has filled in the email settings on the server (the outgoing mail account and the lists of recipients for the monitoring person, brand team and owner). Until then the dashboard still works; it simply says *"Email not sent: no recipients configured"*. Ask your admin to complete this once. If an email seems missing, also check your Spam folder.

9. What to do when a campaign turns amber or red

The dashboard looks at **whole campaigns**. When one is flagged, open it in Meta Ads Manager and look inside it to find which ad set or ad is behind the problem, then follow the steps below. Only the **brand team** changes ads; the monitoring person reports and follows up.

A. High Frequency (Audience Saturation) — the same people see the ad too often

1. Open the campaign and find the ad set with the high frequency.
2. Check how big the audience is and how long this ad set has been running.
3. **WARNING:** widen the audience (add interest layers or raise the lookalike percentage) **or** replace the creative to give the same audience something new.
4. **CRITICAL: pause the ad set now.** The audience is "burned". Create a new ad set with a wider or different audience for the same product.
5. **Do not** simply lower the budget. That only makes the problem last longer without solving it.

B. Low CTR (Underperforming Ads) — hardly anyone clicks

1. Look at which ad in the campaign has the low clicks.
2. **WARNING** (below 0.67%): review the picture, headline and text. Prepare a better version and swap it in if there is no improvement within **3 days**.
3. **CRITICAL** (below 0.43%): **pause the ad** and stop spending on it until a new creative is ready.
4. Tip from our history: Carousel ads usually bring far more clicks (around 1.33% CTR) than Single Image ads (around 0.65%). Check the ad format first.

C. After you fix it

- Tell the monitoring person what you did and when.
- Watch the new ad for its first 3 days.
- Upload a fresh report a few days later. If the campaign is back to Healthy, the colour changes by itself. No one needs to clear the alert by hand.

10. Suggested daily routine

When	Who	What
8:00 AM	Monitoring person	Read the daily digest email. Note anything trending down.
Morning	Monitoring person	Download the latest Campaigns report from Meta and upload it. Read the pop-up if one appears.
Anytime	Monitoring person	Warning: tell the brand team. Critical: tell the brand team and the business owner right away (the email already did, but confirm they saw it).
Same day	Brand team	Open the flagged campaign in Ads Manager, follow the "What to do" steps and report back.
Weekly	Owner / team lead	Look at "Spend at risk" and the Needs attention list. Decide where the budget should move.

11. Quick reference card

Update: Meta Ads Manager → Campaigns → Export table data (.csv) → dashboard → **Import Meta CSV** → Upload & Sync.
Healthy = fine · **Watch** = frequency above 2.5 · **Warning** = frequency above 3.5 or CTR below 0.67% · **Critical** = frequency above 4.5 or CTR below 0.43%.
Emails: Watch → monitoring person · Warning → + brand team · Critical → + owner · Daily digest 8:00 AM.
Never pause based on the CPC chart alone. It is for comparison only.
Always check "data as of" before making a decision.

12. What it can and cannot do

It does	It does not (yet)
• Show the health of every active campaign in one place. • Update every chart in seconds after you upload a report. • Warn with a pop-up and an email, sent to the right people. • Tell you what to do for each problem. • Leave out Reach (FR Stores) and inactive campaigns.	• Update by itself. It needs a new report file each time. • Show day-by-day trends or rank single ads (it works per campaign). • Detect a drop compared with last week or the ad's own average. • Pause or change ads for you. People do that in Meta. • Show real-time numbers.

Live daily numbers can be added later by connecting the dashboard to Meta directly. That requires a special access key from the Meta Business account owner, so it is a separate small project.

13. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
I uploaded a file but nothing changed.	Check the "data as of" line. If it did not update, the file may be the same as before, or the upload showed a red error. Re-export from Meta and upload again.
The upload shows an error.	The file is probably not the Campaigns table, or the columns are missing (especially Amount spent, Impressions, Reach, Link clicks). Re-export with the columns listed in section 6.
A campaign I stopped is still shown.	Old campaigns are not deleted by an upload. Only active campaigns are checked, but an old row can linger. Ask your admin to clean it.
A campaign I expect is missing.	It might be paused/inactive, or it is a Reach ("FR Stores") campaign. Both are ignored on purpose.
No pop-up appeared.	Pop-ups only show for Warning or Critical, and only for new or worse campaigns after an upload (or once when you open the page).
I did not get an email.	Look in Spam. The email only goes out for new or worse campaigns, so an unchanged campaign sends nothing. If the pop-up said "no recipients configured", ask your admin to finish the email setup.
Everything is Healthy but ads feel bad.	The dashboard only sees the report you uploaded. Make sure the date range is recent and that Reach is included.